

SOLOMZI G. GUMBO

Network Engineer | Network Administrator | NOC Engineer
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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Network Engineer and Administrator with 5+ years of experience across enterprise LAN/WAN, cloud networking (Azure, AWS, GCP), firewalls, and routing protocols (BGP, OSPF). Comfortable operating across the full stack from physical data-centre cabling and rack-and-stack through to cloud connectivity, automation, and security hardening. Experienced with Cisco, Palo Alto, and Fortinet platforms. Builds and documents Ansible and Python automation in a hands-on home lab. Strong troubleshooter with a habit of documenting solutions clearly for both technical and non-technical audiences. Available for on-call rotation.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Network & Security Engineer | **ByteHub Solutions** | Pretoria, South Africa *Jan 2024 - Present*

- Design and maintain multi-site hybrid network architecture spanning Azure, AWS, and on-premises infrastructure.
- Deploy and manage firewall policies, IPsec and OpenVPN tunnels, ACLs, and access control across the WAN.
- Configure and manage Azure Load Balancer and cloud network components to ensure application availability and scalability.
- Automate network configuration and deployment tasks using Ansible playbooks and Python scripts, reducing manual effort and configuration drift.
- Monitor network health and security posture using SolarWinds and Splunk; lead root cause analysis for incidents following ITIL process.
- Support data-centre operations including rack-and-stack, cabling, patching, and network equipment installation.
- Produce runbooks, network diagrams, and post-incident reports; present findings clearly to technical and non-technical stakeholders.

Network Technician | **LTE Systems** | Bulawayo, Zimbabwe *Jan 2019 - Dec 2023*

- Administered Cisco-based LAN/WAN infrastructure; led migration from RIPv2 to OSPF, improving convergence and routing efficiency across the organisation.
- Implemented and tuned Palo Alto and Fortinet next-generation firewalls, reducing security incidents by 75% through improved access control and IDS/IPS policy.
- Designed and maintained VLANs, VPN topologies (IPsec), and traffic segmentation to enforce least-privilege connectivity across multiple sites.
- Resolved complex routing, NAT, and security-context issues on Cisco ASA firewalls in multi-context deployments.
- Used Wireshark, Nagios, and Linux CLI for deep-packet analysis and performance optimisation, significantly reducing unplanned downtime.
- Reviewed firewall, event, and system logs for anomaly detection and incident response; collaborated on network deployments and documentation.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Routing & Switching: BGP, OSPF, EIGRP, MPLS, RIP, VLANs, STP, EtherChannel, HSRP, QoS, ACLs, NAT, DHCP, DNS

Firewalls & Security: Palo Alto, Fortinet, Cisco ASA, IDS/IPS, Zero Trust, IPsec/OpenVPN, access control, network hardening

Cloud & Virtualisation: Azure (VNets, Load Balancer, NSGs, ExpressRoute), AWS VPC, GCP; VMware, Hyper-V

Automation & Scripting: Ansible, Python, Docker, Git, Bash, Terraform (learning)

Monitoring & Analysis: SolarWinds, Nagios, Splunk, Wireshark

OS & Platforms: Cisco IOS/IOS-XE, Junos (fundamentals), Linux (CLI/Server), Windows Server

Data Centre: Leaf-spine / IP Fabric architecture, EVPN/VXLAN (learning), rack & stack, cabling, patching

CERTIFICATIONS

- Cisco Certified Network Professional (CCNP) — in progress, 2026
- Cisco Certified Network Associate (CCNA) — Dec 2022

- Certified in Cybersecurity (CC), ISC2 — Jun 2023
- Google Cybersecurity Professional Certificate — Jun 2023

EDUCATION

Diploma in Networking & PC Engineering | [Midlands State University](#) | Bulawayo, Zimbabwe Nov 2021

HOME LAB & PERSONAL PROJECTS

Enterprise Network Simulation [GitHub](#)

Home lab simulating enterprise scenarios with static and dynamic routing (BGP, OSPF, EIGRP), VLANs, STP, Port Security, NAT, DHCP, EtherChannel, HSRP, firewalls, and monitoring via Nagios and Wireshark.

Routing & VLAN Automation [Routing ansible](#) • [Vlan configs ansible](#)

Ansible playbooks automating BGP, OSPF, MPLS, VRF, and VLAN configs across a multi-vendor lab version-controlled, idempotent network config management.

DDoS Simulation & Defence [DDOS script](#)

Python/Docker botnet simulation paired with Ansible-driven mitigation built to study attack patterns and validate network hardening techniques.

SELECTED TECHNICAL WRITING

[OSPF, BGP, MPLS, VRF with Ansible](#) — Automating core routing protocol configs via Ansible playbooks across a multi-router lab.

[Office Lab Series \(3 parts\)](#) — End-to-end hybrid office network: DMZ, WAF, Web VPN, AAA, Syslog, Fortinet firewall, Cisco/Aruba switching.

[DDoS Attack Lab](#) — Docker botnet simulation with Ansible-orchestrated defence; offensive awareness and defence-in-depth.

[MPLS, BGP and OSPF Lab](#) — Label switching fundamentals integrated with BGP and OSPF across a WAN topology.